Don’t Get Forked v0.2 — Table Rulings

For the Storyteller. Every ruling below came out of three full playtests of v0.2 (Puddlecombe, Thistlewick, Gallowsmere plus two rolled towns) — situations the book doesn’t settle yet. None of them is a blocker: the book runs as written. Page numbers are v0.2.

BEFORE THE GAME

- **Print:** an Entity Sheet (p32) and an At the Table page (p33) per player; the town page and its map for the table; pp8–11 (the Entities) to pass round.
- **Dice:** each player needs d4, d6, d8, d10, d12 **plus a second d6 and a second d10 in a different colour** — those are the Mask (d6) and the Monster (d10), so nobody argues about which die “showed”. A 0 on a d10 is 10. Storyteller: d20, d10, 2d6.
- **Tracks:** something for Suspicion, Turns and the Lead (three d20s work).
- **Save 30+ minutes:** have players pick Entities and fill in their sheets before the night (abilities take longest to copy). Set-up from scratch runs 40–50 minutes; each raid about an hour.

SAY THIS AT THE START

> *“Whatever you’re carrying when you’re **captured** is gone for the night — so pass the essentials around. Handing loot to someone in the same place is free.” (p15, p18)*

> *“If you’re caught and it looks bad, you can **give up** at the start of any chase round: you’re captured, no roll.” (p18)*

PICKING ENTITIES

1. **Two players want the same Entity:** roll off, high d6 wins.
2. **Castle Duty clash** (the Mummy and Jekyll both default to Librarian; Dracula and the Ghost both Butler): go round the table in seating order; whoever comes later gives way. When rolling a Duty, **reroll any Duty already taken or whose kind isn’t on the shopping list**, while a useful one is left.
3. **Random Gift or Perk that can’t matter this raid** (e.g. Strong Back when the town has no Huge furniture): reroll it.
4. **Players may see the town page and map** (traits, Difficulties, watched, ways in) before choosing where to go.

DURING THE RAID

5. **Same-size dice:** read the coloured die as the Mask/Monster (rule above).
6. **Jekyll & a friend’s “Monster without Suspicion”** (Unseen, Good Dog…): if the Monster shows, Hyde still takes over — at no Suspicion.
7. **An own approach at a way in** picks that way in for the whole party even if the roll fails. Warn the player first.
8. **Tell check with several arrivals:** odd/even for two; for three, roll a d6 (1–2, 3–4, 5–6).
9. **Furniture:** taking it is free, then or on a later Turn, and it can be left behind (stops the tick). Both carriers of a Huge piece spend their action on every Turn of the move.
10. **Ghost’s Spectral + passing the loot** OPTIONAL: as written, the Ghost can pass a group obstacle with no roll, hand the item to a friend, and do it again. If that feels too easy at your table: **Spectral doesn’t work on a location’s last obstacle.**

LOCAL CHASES

11. **The mob’s Difficulty** uses Suspicion **after** the roll that got you caught (as in the Example of Play). It then stays fixed.
12. **Giving up:** decide **before** the Storyteller rolls the ground. Giving up before any roll raises no Suspicion (no rolls, no rise).
13. **Overdraws:** at most **one overdraw per local chase**. (Points past the Limit are lost, so otherwise a doomed runner overdraws for free all night.)
14. **A chase with no Trouble and no Monster showing raises nothing** when it ends.
15. **Fear the Curse / Night Runner (“when you flee alone”)** mean alone **when the chase starts**; they don’t switch on if a partner gives up.
16. **Huge piece, one carrier caught:** the piece stays with the other carrier and can’t move until both are free; if either is **captured**, the town takes it (p15).
17. **Long chases** OPTIONAL: if a chase passes round 6, end it: Lead 2+ escapes, otherwise captured. (Two test chases ran 15 rounds.)
18. **At Suspicion 8+** the mob is 12 and a lone runner rarely escapes — remind the player they can give up.

THE FINAL FLIGHT

19. **Abilities as raises:** any signature or Gift — approaches and the Draught included — may be spent **as a raise on any runner’s roll**, ignoring the ability’s own conditions (“not while carrying”, “watched obstacle only”). Practised Hand’s free change back doesn’t make a raise free.
20. **Overdraws** work as written (once a flight). A “Soon” Entity overdrawing in round 2 gets it nearly free — that’s fine for tonight.

THE WAY OUT & THE LIMIT

21. **A roll’s result comes first** (p16): a way-out Success that also hits the Limit gets the party out; so does a rescue’s.
22. Expect players to **let the Monster out at the way out** — a Success or Cost gets everyone out and costs nothing there. That’s working as written.